# CHAPTER-III

## *ARTHĀPATTI* IN PRĀBHĀKARA MĪMĀṀSĀ SCHOOL

# CHAPTER-III

# *ARTHĀPATTI* IN PRĀBHĀKARA MĪMĀṀSĀ SCHOOL

## 3.1 Importance of the School:

Prabhākara Miśra, who is the disciple of the great sage Jaimini, has founded a different sect of Mīmāṁsā school, namely Prābhākara Mīmāṁsā school. He writes two commentaries *Vṛhatī* and *Laghvī*, which are based on Śabara's *Bhāṣya*. Śālikanātha writes *Prakaraṇa Pañcikā* following the view of Prabhākara. The view of Prabhākara is well-known as '*gurumat*'. Prabhākara's philosophy draws our attention due to his two theories having some special features unlike other schools of Indian Philosophy viz. the theory of cognition, which is known as *triputipratyakṣavāda*, and the theory of error, which is known as *akhyātivāda*.

Moreover, for the present context, the view of Prabhākara Miśra is critical, like that of Kumārila. Prabhākara also accepts *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an independent and separate instrument of valid cognition. However, his view regarding the nature of *arthāpatti* (presumption) is different from that of Kumārila. According to Prabhākara, *arthāpatti* (presumption) serves to resolve doubts. However, according to Kumārila, *arthāpatti* (presumption) is used to resolve the contradiction between two apparently inconsistent facts.

The task of this chapter is to discuss the nature of *arthāpatti* critically and an attempt will be made to bring in light the debate between Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsā and Prābhākara Mīmāṁsā schools regarding the classification of *arthāpatti*. The apocalyptic of the rejection of the *śrutārthāpatti* by Prābhākara Mīmāṁsā will be presented with some substantive arguments. Finally, an observation will be made that the Prābhākara school is bound to accept the *śrutārthāpatti* like the *dṛṣṭārthāpatti* though they have denied such type of *arthāpatti* as per their metaphysical standpoint.

### 3.2 Nature of *Arthāpatti*:

Prabhākara Miśra says in his commentary *Vṛhatī* that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is the assumption of a fact for explaining another fact to resolve their conflict otherwise there is no basis for dispelling doubts.[100] The word 'conflict' means the impossibility of the existence of a thing without the existence of another thing. If this is the case, then it can easily be said that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is nothing but the inference of a cause from its effect, as the existence of an effect cannot be possible without its cause. Thus, it is seen that *arthāpatti* (presumption) is not a different instrument of valid cognition other than inference. But, according to the Prābhākara school, *arthāpatti* is, in fact, different from inference. *Arthāpatti* (presumption) is different from inference in the sense that the conclusion in inference is derived from the invariable concomitance (*vyāpti*). But the cognition of invariable concomitance (*vyāpti*) is not a condition of *arthāpatti* (presumption). Furthermore, Prabhākara says that whatever is the case of *arthāpatti* (presumption) is the reverse process of inference. We can illustrate this view like that: the movement of thought in inference is from the *anupapanna* to the *upapādaka* while in the case of *arthāpatti* (presumption) the movement of thought is from the *upapādaka* to the *anupapanna*.

Śālikanātha Miśra says in his *Prakaraṇa Pañcikā*,

"*vinā kalpanayā arthena dṛṣṭenānupannatām.*

*nayatā dṛśṭamarthaṁ yā sā arthāpattistu kalpanā*".[101]

The assumption of something which is the object of perception but another object in the same context is also raised out of the perception, which is called *arthāpatti* (presumption). More clearly is to say that when an object is known through perception, but apart from that, the certainty of another object is established out of

---

[100] "*tena meyānapekṣasya sandigdhatvādhetutā. / hetutvaṁ yavati tvasti ato nānyat pramīyate*." *Vṛhatī*.

[101] *Prakaraṇa Pañcikā*, p. 273.

perception; there, the assumption to remove the contradiction between perception and the certainty of the object is *arthāpatti*.

Arthur B. Keith says, "Presumption in his [Prabhākara] view arises when it is necessary to assume some fact in order to avoid inconsistency in respect of something which is actually perceived".[102] Prabhākara holds that we should recognize *arthāpatti* (presumption) as an independent instrument of valid cognition because of its one of the critical characteristics, i.e., doubt as a cause for emergence of *arthāpatti*. This characteristic makes *arthāpatti* (presumption) different from *anumāna* (inference). Because there is no room for doubt being a cause in inference. In inference doubt plays a role of initiating the inferential process only. Prabhākara accepts doubt as an element of *arthāpatti* (presumption), whereas Kumārila accepts conflict (*virodha* or *anupapatti*) between two facts/sentences as cause of the *arthāpatti*.

It is important to discuss regarding the role of doubt in inferential cognition as well as *arthāpatti*. When we are going to the process of inferential cognition, then we have seen that there is a small function in doubt. One is going to infer from a certain mark which is technically called as probans (*hetu*). Inference starts its' journey from a probans which should be free from all type of fallacy and doubt. Inferential cognition cannot be generated from doubt of the mark. If any fallacy appears in probans then such types of inference will be treated as *hetvavāsa*. However, an important point is that inferential cognition may be produced due to the presence of willingness to construct an *anumāna* what is called as *anumitsā*. Again, *anumitsā* can be generated when someone have a doubt about what is to be established which is technically called probandum (*sādhya*). Because inferential cognition cannot be generated about something of which the cognizer is certain. If a person knows the probandum (*sādhya*) certainly, then there is no need to have the inferential cognition.

The instrument that assumes an interpretation to resolve an otherwise present doubt is called *arthāpatti*. If the probans is doubtful in case of inferential cognition, it will not be *anumāna*. However, according to Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas, the doubtful matter will be compatible with *arthāpatti*. By the term conflict (*anupapatti*), the

---

[102] Keith, Arthur. B. *The Karma-Mīmāṁsā*, Oxford University Press, London, 1921, p. 33.

Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas understand to a doubtful fact. For example, if Devadatta who is not inside the house, and unless he is somewhere outside the house, then it is not possible of his aliveness. Such type of conflict directs to doubt. In the case of the cited instance, the doubt about the existence of Devadatta's aliveness what is said by an astrologer will naturally appear from his absence in house, in that doubt, the absence of Devadatta will be an alternative (*koṭi*) and Devadatta's aliveness what is said by an astrologer will also be another alternative (*koṭi*). However, according to the conclusion of Devadatta's aliveness from astrology, whether Devadatta exist in another place as he is a centenarian will be another alternative (*koṭi*). The alternatives that are expressed by a sentence, for Prābhākara, is called conflict. The doubt represents by the confliction is the progenitor of the instrument of *arthāpatti*. Therefore, doubt is not a cause in the case of inference, but doubt does have a role as being a cause in the case of *arthāpatti* (presumption). That is why Nandiśvara says in his *Prabhākara-Vijaya*, "*yadarthāntareṇa āpāditasandehaṁ kalpayate sā arthāpattiḥ. Anumāne tu a sandigdhaṁ sandehāpādakaṁ vā gamakam. ataḥ sāmagrībhedādeva bhedaḥ atra ca anupapattiśbdena sandeha evocyate*"[103].

### 3.3 *Karaṇa* of *Arthāpatti*:

Prabhākara disagrees with Kumārila regarding which one exactly is the instrument, i.e., *karaṇa* in the case of *arthāpatti*. In this regard, the view of Prabhākara is wholly opposed to the view of Kumārila. It is important to note that the view of Prabhākara is not consistent with that of Śabara also. Śabara observes that the seen or heard fact is unexplained, and this inexplicability is the means or instrument of knowing what explains it. Prabhākara, on the other hand, holds that the thing or the fact to be known through *arthāpatti* is unexplained. Prabhākara has attempted to avoid the inconsistency in question by changing the order of words in the statement made by Śabara in this regard: from "*dṛṣṭaḥ śruto vārtho'nyathā nopapadyate*

---

[103] Nandiśvara, *Prabhākara-Vijaya*, p. 54.

*ityarthakalpanā*"[104] to "*dṛṣṭaḥ śruto vārtho'rthakalpanā anyathā nopapadyate iti*"[105], which implies that in *arthāpatti* a seen or heard fact is the instrument of knowing the other fact which is inexplicable without the former one.

However, if a careful scrutiny is made, then it can be understood that Prabhākara's view cannot be accepted. In fact, the cognition of the thing which is inexplicable cannot be attained from that by which it is taught to be explained. In order to substantiate this position, one example may be cited. If what is said by Prabhākara is true, then the cognition of *śiṁśapā*-ness from the perception of treeness would be correct, simply because *śiṁśapā*-ness cannot be explained without treeness. *Śiṁśapā* cannot be *śiṁśapā* if it is not a tree, but can we say that a tree is *śiṁśapā* as it is a tree? Certainly not. It is seen that in *arthāpatti*, the *upapādaka* is known from the *anupapanna*. In the example which is mentioned earlier, Devadatta's existence outside the house is known, which explains the absence of Devadatta in the house. According to Prabhākara, the absence of Devadatta in the house, which is a known fact, is not inexplicable. However, if Prabhākara's view is taken to be true, it is unless to assume his existence outside, for the known fact is supposed to be explained by itself. Prabhākara holds that actually, Devadatta's existence outside the home is inexplicable. Again, this view also cannot be accepted. When the hearer is aware of the absence of Devadatta in the house, what he cognizes is not that Devadatta's presence outside is inexplicable, but he cognizes that Devadatta is outside the house.

### 3.4 Śālikanātha's view on *Arthāpatti*:

Śālikanātha tries to substantiate the position of Prabhākara in this regard. A little reflection shows that the presence of Devadatta outside the house without the non-existence of him in the house is not inexplicable. What is inexplicable is the existence of Devadatta without presuming his existence outside when he is not found

---

[104] Bhatt, Govardhan. P. *The Basic Ways of Knowing*, Motilal Banarsidass Pvt. Ltd., Delhi, 1989, p. 311.

[105] Ibid., p. 311.

in the house. If a fact is opposed to some instrument of valid cognition, only then inexplicability comes into being. It is known by some instruments of valid cognition that Devadatta is alive, but the contradiction arises when we come to know that he is not in the house. This contradiction shows that the fact of Devadatta's being alive is doubtful. One who does not find Devadatta in his house becomes doubtful whether Devadatta is really alive or not. Unless and until the presence of Devadatta outside is presumed, his doubt is not dispelled. *Arthāpatti* consists of three steps:

1. In the first step, there is the cognition of the absence of Devadatta in the house.
2. In the second step, this cognition comes in conflict with the fact that Devadatta is alive, which gives birth to doubt, and
3. In the third step, the existence of Devadatta outside the house is presumed, and thereby the doubt is dispelled.

Thus, it is seen that it is the cognition of the non-existence of Devadatta in the house, which gives birth to the inexplicability in question. Here, the fact that Devadatta is alive becomes inexplicable, and the cognition that Devadatta is alive is a result coming from the presumption of Devadatta's existence from outside. Śālikanātha states that it is not the apparent inconsistency, but the doubt that makes a distinction between *arthāpatti* (presumption) and inference. In an inferential cognition, the probandum is established on the basis of a well-established relation between probans and probandum, but in *arthāpatti*, the cognition is based on a doubtful fact. Doubt is the progenitor of *arthāpatti*. In this context, Nandīśvara says in his *Prabhākara-Vijaya*, "*yadarthāntareṇa āpāditasandehaṁ kalpayate sā arthāpattiḥ. anumāne tu na sandigdhaṁ sandehāpādakaṁ va gamakam. ataḥ sāmagrīvedādeba vedaḥ atra ca anupapattiśabdena sndeha evocyate*."[106]

---

[106] *Prabhākara-Vijaya*, p. 54.

### 3.5 Pārthasārthi's view on *Arthāpatti*:

Pārthasārthi has vehemently criticized the above view of Śālikanātha. Pārthasārthi says that the presumption of the existence of Devadatta outside the house cannot be based on the fact that Devadatta is alive, only because this fact itself becomes the subject of doubt. If we are not sure whether Devadatta is dead or alive, how can we assume that he is outside? When someone is in doubt whether Devadatta is alive or not, then his doubt cannot be removed only through the *arthāpatti* (presumption) of the fact that he is outside. Pārthasārthi says that doubt is dispelled only through the removal of the cause of doubt or doubt may be removed when any one of the alternatives is confirmed by a more potent instrument of valid cognition. In the present case, the cause of doubt is the non-existence of Devadatta in the house. However, if we presume Devadatta's existence outside, then the cause of doubt is confirmed instead of removing the same. If someone presumes that Devadatta is outside the house, then it implies the non-existence of Devadatta in the house, which is actually the cause of doubt. Actually, Devadatta's outside the house is known through supposition, but not through any more potent instrument of valid cognition like perception. It is further said that the supposition in question confirms none of the alternatives. The alternatives are either Devadatta is alive, or he is dead. From the fact that Devadatta is outside, we cannot conclude beyond doubt whether he is alive or he is dead. Thus, it is seen that *arthāpatti* (presumption) based on the non-existence of Devadatta in the house cannot remove the doubt. No conscious person can conclude that Devadatta is outside and alive because he is not present in the house. Devadatta's life was first known as sure and rendered doubtful due to his absence in the house. However, it is absolutely absurd to maintain that doubt itself is the cause of its removal. If someone is sure that Devadatta is alive and if again he entertains doubt about Devadatta's being alive due to some reasons, he intends to remove the doubt is right due to some reliable person. If the person in question becomes right about the fact that Devadatta is really alive only then, he can conclude that he must be outside as Devadatta is alive and not at home. So, our preceding discussion shows that doubt cannot be recognized as the distinguishing mark for *arthāpatti* (presumption).

### 3.6 Classification of *Arthāpatti*:

Kumārila admits two sorts of *arthāpatti* (presumption) following the commentary where it is clearly stated as '*dṛṣṭaḥ śruto vā*'. However, Prabhākara does not accept this division of *arthāpatti* (presumption). According to Prabhākara, there is only one sort of *arthāpatti*, i.e., *dṛṣṭārthāpatti*. He refutes *arthāpatti* from a sentence or word. Prabhākara observes that the meaning of the word *'śruto'* is not different from the meaning of the word '*dṛṣṭa*'. Both of them have been used in the same sense. '*Dṛṣṭa*' means well-known, and *'śruto'*, according to Prabhākara, is also used to mean the same thing.

Thus, in the case of *arthāpatti*, the fact plays an important role rather than a word. When someone listens to a sentence and faces a conflict, then the person assumes a fact for resolving the conflict. However, if the man assumes another word for resolving the conflict, then the presumption is not possible for the absence of the word's meaning. In supporting the view of Prabhākara, Śālikanātha says that whatever is assumed on hearing the sentence 'Caitra who is fat does not eat during the day' is the fact of eating at night instead of the sentence 'he eats at night'. Because if someone does not know the meaning of the word 'night', then how can he assume the word? The conflict is between fatness and fasting, but not between the words 'Caitra is fat' and 'he does not eat during the day'. So, it should be admitted that the immediate cause for resolving the conflict is the assumption of a fact, but not of words. Moreover, for the *dṛṣṭārthāpatti,* the cognition of the presumed fact, e.g., Devadatta's existence outside, is verbalized, like the case of determinate (*savikalpaka*) cognition. Likewise, when a person cognizes the fact that 'Caitra eats at night', such type of cognition is also verbalized.

Nevertheless, the objection raised by Prabhākara is not always tenable. Because when someone assumed a fact for resolving the conflict between two facts, at that time, the assumption of the fact cannot be completed without assuming the corresponding words or sentences also. In supporting Kumārila's view regarding *śrutārthāpatti*, Sucaritā Miśra[107] gives an argument. Though it is true that the conflict

---

[107] The author of *Kāśikā* based on *Ślokavārttika* of Kumārila Bhaṭṭa.

of a heard sentence is primarily a conflict of fact and the conflict is resolved through another fact, but the conflict of the sentence can be removed only by the assumption of another sentence; in the sense that one cannot resolve the conflict only through the fact without mentioning the corresponding sentence. This view can be explained with the help of an example: suppose someone says the word '*pacati*' (cooks), and after listening to the word, the hearer expects another word, i.e., '*odanam*' (rice), and after adding the word '*odanam*' the word '*pacati*' fulfills the expectation; otherwise, it cannot. So, the view of Kumārila is more logical than that of Prabhākara, in the sense that Kumārila holds sentences, as well as facts, are necessary for resolving the conflict between the two.

Similarly, when an incomplete sentence needs another sentence, the expectancy in question can be resolved only by assuming that sentence. However, the expectancy should be related to assuming the corresponding fact. Thus, it is seen that the view of Prabhākara cannot be accepted.

### 3.7 Prabhākara's view on *Śāstra Pramāṇa*:

Our discussion regarding the classification of *arthāpatti* can be more conceited if one tries to link it with what Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas mean by verbal cognition. The difficulty of the division of *arthāpatti* arises due to the non-acceptance of *laukika śabda* by the Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas. They only accept the *Vedic śabda*. That is why Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas refute *śrutārthāpatti*. The *Veda* is called a *śāstra*, and this is why the verbal cognition of Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas is called *śāstra-pramāṇa*. Śālikanātha says,

"*tatra pañcavidhaṁ mānaṁ pratyakṣamanumā tathā.*

*śāstraṁ tathopamānārthāpattiriti gurormatam*."[108]

i.e., the object which is not known by *pratyakṣa*, *anumāna*, *upamāna,* and *arthāpatti* is called *śabda*. According to this definition, only the *Vedic śabda* is worthy of being

[108] *Prakaraṇa Pañcikā*, p. 10.

an independent instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*). Prabhākara says that *laukika śabda* can be verified through the other instrument of valid cognition, i.e., *anumāna*. That is why *laukika śabda* is not accepted as a *śabda* - "*pramāṇāntarasannikṛṣṭārthārthaviṣayaṁ tu laukikaṁ vacanam. ... ato na śāstram*."[109]

Prabhākara defines *śabda pramāṇa* following Śabara as "*śāstraḥ śabdavijñānādasannikṛṣte arthe vijñānam*"[110]. In this definition, the term '*asannikṛṣta*' means something which is unknown and not contradicted by any cognition known through *pratyakṣa*, *anumāna*, *upamāna,* and *arthāpatti*. So, the cognition of an object which is not known earlier and not contradictory to cognition known through *pratyakṣa*, *anumāna*, *upamāna,* and *arthāpatti*, is called *śābda* and the means of such type of cognition is called *śāstra pramāṇa*.[111] The extraordinary object is discussed in the *Veda* and is also not known by the other instrument of valid cognition. That is why *śāstra* is the only *pramāṇa* for such an extraordinary object in the *Veda*. *Śāstra* is the only instrument for *Vedic vākya,* and this truth has also been said in *Mīmāṁsā-Sūtra*, "*codanālakṣaṇaḥ arthaḥ dharma*"[112]. *Śāstra* is the only *pramāṇa* to such object which is not known through perception, etc.; it also produces a presage of human beings.

### 3.8 *Vedic Śabda*:

In our preceding discussion, it is seen that Prabhākara Mīmāṁsā accepts only the *Vedic śabda*. They argue that the *laukika śabda* can be known by the other *pramāṇa*. That is why *laukika śabda* is not '*asannikṛṣta*'. Although in some cases, *laukika śabda* may also be immune from doubt, there are cases where it may not be

---

[109] *Tantrarahasya*, p. 22.

[110] *Vṛhatī*:1-1-5, p. 105.

[111] "*asannikṛṣta iti kimidam? pramāṇāntareṇa apratīta iti*." *Prakaraṇa Pañcikā*, p. 234.

[112] *Jaimini-Sūtra*: 1-1-2.

immune from doubt. For this reason, *laukika śabda* is not always undoubtful. However, in the *Veda*-s, all *śabda*-s are used in the sense of irreversible. The *Veda* is not written by any of the perceptible entities like human beings. There is no scope of defraudation or reversation of the meaning of the *Veda* by human beings. Therefore, there is no doubt regarding the *Vedic* sentences. However, *laukika śabda* is doubtitious either directly or indirectly. There is a scope of misuse of *laukika śabda* due to the lack of a proper understanding of the meaning of the hearer or owing to the bad intention of the speaker. By definition, human beings are limited beings, they have reasoning power. *Laukika śabda* and the meaning of such *śabda* are not unanimously accepted. Different interpretations are possible by other human beings. That is why there is a scope of doubt in the case of *laukika śabda*. As a particular sentence is interpreted in a single sense, there is no unanimity; how can the validity of *laukika śabda* be proved? Ordinary people have always used the meaning according to the *śabda*. Śālikanātha has said this in his *Prakaraṇa Pañcikā* as "*laukikaṁ vākyaṁ nārthe svayaṁ niścayamutpādayati. laukikavacasāmanṛtabhūyiṣṭhatvādarthabhyavicārasya śaṅkitvāt. ...yukta stāvat laukike vacasi sandehaḥ. puruṣā hi prāyeṇa anantvitārthāni eva padānyāśayadoṣena bhramaṇa, pramādena, aśaktyā vā prayaṅjanā dṛśyante. tataśca yadyapi taduktānāṁ padānamanvitābhidhānasāmarthyam asti, tathāpyanvitārthaśaṅkayā nāścayo niścīyate*."[113]

### 3.9 *Laukika Śabda*:

Someone may say that *laukika śabda* is not always doubtful. In many of the cases, the *laukika śabda* can make a real sense, and Śālikanātha has also supported it. To quote "*arthasaṁśayenāpi loko vyvahārati. sandigdhāyamapi vṛṣṭo vṛṣṭyāofale kṛṣyādikarmāṇi pravartante*."[114] It refers to the certainty of *laukika śabda* in cases where defects are absent. The defects of *laukika śabda* are due to a lack of grasping

---

[113] *Prakaraṇa Pañcikā*, p. 243.

[114] Ibid., p. 243.

the proper meaning of the hearer or due to some defects of the speaker like bad intention, etc. Misunderstanding in daily life shows that *laukika śabda* and the meaning of such *śabda* are not always appropriately grasped. That is why there is a scope of doubt in the case of *laukika śabda*. *Laukika śabda*, for Prabhākara, is non-eternal, but the *Vedic śabda* is eternal and impersonal. However, it can be said that *laukika śabda* is not always doubtful. In many cases, the *laukika śabda* may make real sense. While cultivating, the farmers now-a-days participate in *kṛṣakbandhu* programs on TV or Radio where experts of crops being present give suggestions, and the farmers cultivate accordingly and get desired results, or hear the weather telecast and get prepared for planning for the date of cultivation. Hence, the authority of persons in their fields cannot be denied in daily life. That is why the Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas say that a sentence from a person can be appropriately used if the person is devoid of illusion and inattention. However, such type of certainty can be known through inference, according to Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas.

The sentence uttered by human beings has always been dependent on the speaker's intention. Because each sentence has a different meaning. In the field of sentence meaning, human beings have used sentences for a specific intention, and the hearer can understand such intention through inference. That is why Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas refute *laukika śabda* as an independent instrument of valid cognition and reduce its instrumentality into *anumāna* (inference). If one becomes certain of the meaning of the sentence through inference, then doubt of the proper meaning of the sentence is removed. The sentence is accepted as a render (*anuvāda*) by the hearer again. In such a way, the meaning of the *laukika śabda* can be understood.

So, Prabhākara Mīmāṁsakas do not deny *laukika vākya*, but they refute its independent instrumentality. The meaning of *laukika vākya* is possible through inference. Such type of *laukika vākya*-s is not a case of *śabda* or *śāstra* according to this school. It is also worthy to note that Vaiśeṣika[115] and Bauddha schools include *laukika* and *Vedic* both types of *śabda,* into inference.

---

[115] "*śabdādīnāmapyanumāne antarbhābaḥ samānavidhitvāt*."

- Praśastapāda, *Praśastapādabhāṣyam*, Daṇdiswāmī Dāmodarāśrama (Tr. & Ed.), Vol. II, Sanskrit Book Dipo, Kolkata, 2017, p. 357.

On the other hand, Naiyāyikas accept *laukika* and *Vedic*, both types of *śabda*, as an independent instrument of valid cognition (*pramāṇa*).[116] Naiyāyikas and Bhāṭṭa schools also accept both sorts of *śabda* (*laukika* and *Vedic*) as an independent instrument of valid cognition. This truth has been mentioned in *Mānameyodaya* as "*tacca śābdaṁ dvividhaṁ pauruṣeyamapauruṣeyaṁ ca. tatrāptavacaḥ pauruṣeyaṁ, vedavacaḥ apouruṣeyam*…."[117] However, the Naiyāyikas and the Bhāṭṭas do not go hand in hand in explaining the nature of *śabda*.

### 3.10 Adoption of two sorts of *Arthāpatti*:

According to the Bhāṭṭa school, one can know the sense or meaning of a sentence without having inferential cognition of the sentence. However, the question may arise that how can that be possible? In response to this question, it is said by the Bhāṭṭas that this is possible like the *Vedic* sentence. Both of the Mīmāṁsā schools accept the *Veda* as a non-authoritative (*apauruṣeya*). So, there is no author of the *Veda*. Prabhākara Mīmāṁsakas also accept the possibility of a sense of the *Vedic* sentence. In that case, one can know the sense of the *Vedic* sentence without having inferential cognition. Likewise, in the *Vedic* sentence, the sense of a *laukika* sentence is possible without inferential cognition.

Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas do not deny the use of *laukika vākya*, but they refute its independent instrumentality. According to them, the validity of *laukika vākya* is possessed through inference. Such type of *laukika vākya* is not a *śabda* or *śāstra vākya* according to this school. Because the very form of inferential cognition is: wherever there is *āptatva* of a person, there is also authenticity in the uttered sentence of that person. The person X has *āptatva*. Therefore, the uttered sentence of person X has authenticity. But, the Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṁsakas may ask: how can the *āptatva* of X be determined? The *āptatva* of X can be determined by verifying sentences uttered by X.

---

[116] "*vākyaṁ dvividhaṁ - vaidikaṁ, laukikaṁ ca. vaidikamīśvaroktatvāt sarvameva pramāṇam. laukikaṁ tvāpoktam pramāṇam*." *Tarkasaṁgraha*, p. 490.

[117] *Mānomeyadaya*: 53-32-6, p. 177.

If it is found that wherever there is the utterance of X, there is authenticity, then we can certify that X is the person having *āptatva*. Thus, the verification of a sentence comes first, and then only the certification of *āptatva* comes, and not vice-versa. That is why Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas are bound to accept that the *āptatva* always depends on the verified sentence. At first, the certainty of a sentence is determined by corresponding facts. Therefore, for a meaning of a sentence *āptatva* cannot be treated as probans. So, the fundamental question is truth or falsity of a sentence that Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas accept as a probandum. The establishment of probans is impossible without the probandum in this case. If the truth of the sentence is not certain, the *āptatva* itself becomes insecure. In this context, the Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas are bound to accept the *laukika śabda*. They should accept *laukika śabda* for capturing its sense or meaning. Therefore, the Bhāṭṭas position regarding the two sorts of *arthāpatti* (presumption) viz. *dṛṣṭārthāpatti* and *śrutārthāpatti*, is tenable in this context.

Moreover, the scriptural texts like the *Veda*, etc., not only deal with *Vedic śabda* instead but there is also the *śabda* which is for human beings. The *Veda* is not written by any person. The *Veda* is not found in written form as it is impersonal (*apauruṣeya*). Whatever we have found regarding the *Veda* as it is verbally said by the great sages at different times reciprocally. Now a question comes: Whatever is claimed by human beings about sacrifice, etc., those are followed by the *Veda*, is accepted as valid or not?

In most cases, we have found ritualistic concepts from human beings. We do not have any cognition regarding the *Veda* without the utterance of human beings as there is no written form of the *Veda*. Are these types of *śabda* or sentence *laukika* or *Vedic*? The response is that they are obviously *laukika* though it is claimed that they have come from the *Veda*. If such types of *śabda* are denoted as *laukika śabda*, then how can we deny the validity of *laukika śabda* as a unique form of *śabda pramāṇa*. Therefore, the Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas are bound to accept the *laukika śabda* with its unique form of truth.

Another point is that if the Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas accept the *śabda pramāṇa* as the only *śāstra pramāṇa* by which we come to know the *Vedic*

injunctions, etc., the question comes on the acceptance of orthodox philosophy. We can clearly mention this through the help of the Vaiśeṣika school. Because it is clearly stated in the *Vaiśeṣika-Sūtra* that this school belongs to the orthodox school as they accept the authority of the *Veda*. However, they do not accept the *śabda pramāṇa* as an independent instrument of valid cognition. They have accepted two instruments of valid cognition, viz. perception, and inference. They hold that the sentences, whatever is said in the *Veda* can be known through inference. Now, the question comes: Can the Vaiśeṣika school be called orthodox as they do not accept *śabda pramāṇa*? According to the Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas, *śabda pramāṇa* can be used only as the instrument of valid cognition to know the *Vedic śabda*. The point is whether the acceptance of the authority of the *Veda* leads to the acceptance of *śabda pramāṇa* or not. In this context, Daya Krishna also states, "After all, does not one of the so-called 'orthodox' schools of Indian philosophy, that is, the Vaiśeṣika does not accept *śabda* or testimony as an independent source of valid knowledge?"[118]

### 3.11 Observation:

The *Brahma-Sūtra* is a scriptural text written by Vedavyāsa. Later on, the *Brahma-Sūtra* is interpreted differently by the different monks. If the scriptural texts are eternal, the question arises: whether there can be different interpretations? The Pūrva Mīmāṁsā and the Uttara Mīmāṁsā (known as Vedānta) are the two schools of orthodox philosophy based on the *Brahma-Sūtra*. If the scriptural texts are eternal, why there are two different schools based on the same text? Different schools come into existence as there are different interpretations. Interpretations are the work of authoritative persons. If so, then why do we accept these two schools differently as the Prābhākara Mīmāṁsakas accept the eternity of scriptural text? Questions are not raised regarding the eternity of scriptural Texts; the question arises regarding the acceptance of interpretations. Acceptance of different interpretations of the *Brahma-Sūtra* follows the acceptance of *laukika śabda* as well as the *Vedic śabda*. If there is

---

[118] Krishna, Daya. *Indian Philosophy: A Counter Perspectives*, Oxford University Press, Delhi, 1991, p. 10.

no scope of interpretation by *laukika śabda*, then such type of classification becomes meaningless. That is why Daya Krishna says, "If, therefore, we deny the 'authoritative' character of Indian philosophy then, in an important sense, we deny the concept of 'schools' also. There are no such thing as final, frozen positions which the term 'school', in the context of Indian philosophy, usually connote. If 'schools' change, develop, differentiate and divide, then they are never closed, finished or final with respect to what they are trying to say. There could, then, be no fixed body of Nyāya, Vaiśeṣika, Sāṁkhya, Mīmāṁsā, Vedānta, Buddhist, Jain or Cārvāka positions except in a minimal sense. … The case of Indian philosophical schools would then be similar."[119] Therefore, it is observed that Prābhākar Mīmāṁsakas are bound to accept the *śrutārthāpatti* like the *dṛṣṭārthāpatti* as *śrutārthāpatti* is based on both the *laukika śabda* and the *Vedic śabda*.

[119] Ibid., pp. 13-14.